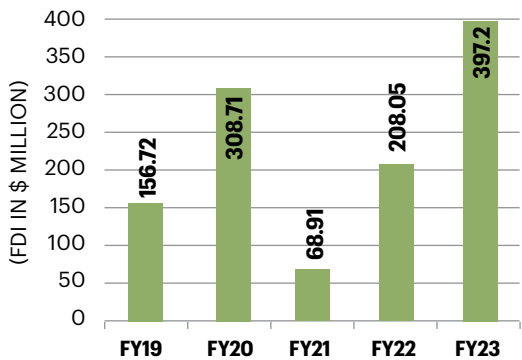


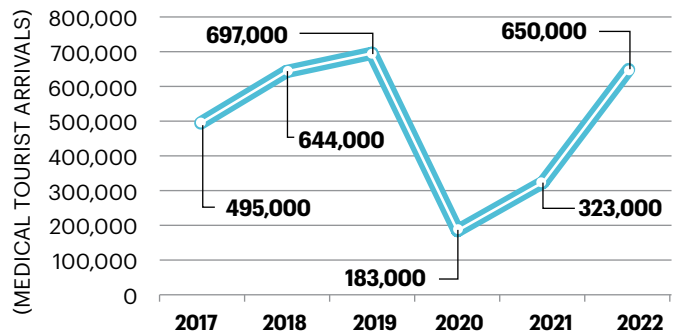
...And in the medical and surgical appliance sector, FDI has grown 26 per cent



SOURCE DPIIT, MINISTRY OF COMMERCE

SUN AND SURGERY

The number of foreigners visiting India for medical treatment has risen after a dip during Covid-19



SOURCE BUREAU OF IMMIGRATION

sionals and thriving consumer tech ecosystem, India is uniquely positioned to become the cradle of global healthtech innovation,” says Srinivasan.

As part of the “Digital India” project, the country has set up 638 e-Hospitals, effectively improving healthcare services nationwide.

The government says its eSanjeevani telemedicine service has been highly successful, hosting over 30 million teleconsultations by 2022 and breaking records with more than 170,000 consultations in one day.

Pavan Choudary, Chairman of the Medical Technology Association of India (MTaI), an organisation that represents the medical technology (medtech) industry in India, says that, by fostering an environment of strategic partnership and cooperation, “G20 countries can collectively address global healthcare challenges and drive advancements in medical technology solutions.”

HOW THE G20 CAN PROVIDE A FIX

The healthcare and pharmaceuticals sector has several hurdles to cross, such as disparities in quality and availability between urban and rural areas, the lack of a proper three-tier system, which sends

patients rushing to research hospitals at the apex for simple surgeries, and prohibitive costs in the private sector.

In drugs and pharmaceuticals, maintaining quality standards is a challenge. Inadequate research and development investment limits innovation, while counterfeit drugs impact the industry. Integrating digital health solutions, raising public health awareness and addressing supply chain disruptions are additional hurdles.

But Mansukh Mandaviya, the Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare, is upbeat because he feels the G20 role will help India tackle many hurdles. “As part of India’s proposals, the agenda focusses on digital health and innovation to advance the use of technology in healthcare service delivery. The aim is to bridge the digital divide globally and promote digital public goods,” says Mandaviya.

India is now banking on its prowess in IT to help overcome some issues such as reaching quality healthcare to remote corners (with telemedicine), keeping records (like the Aarogya Setu app) and sharing best practices globally. **BT**

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